

Astral Projection - The deliberate relocation of perceptual awareness away from the physical senses into a "vehicle" designed to house individual consciousness within a fundamentally different environment where objects, thoughts, and emotions may be experienced in fundamentally different ways than they are from the perspective of the physical world.

Athanor - The internal psychic furnace in which transformation occurs. Symbolically, the Athanor is sustained attention under pressure. In another sense, it represents the capacity to hold contradiction, suffering, and intent long enough for genuine transmutation to occur.

Babe of the Abyss - A state of initiation associated with the sephirah Binah on the Tree of Life. A Babe of the Abyss has descended into the Abyss and successfully surrendered everything, thereby encountering the floor of the Abyss.²⁴⁸ However, due to a variety of possible circumstances²⁴⁹, the Babe is not yet ready to begin constructing their Palace. This grade indicates *incomplete attainment* and is considered a *temporary* state, persisting only until the blocking condition is resolved, at which point the title of Magister Templi may be assumed.

Black Brother - An initiate who refuses to surrender their egoic identity upon entering the Abyss. They attempt to preserve separateness through fixation on form, power, or personal immortality. The Black Brother halts development by mistaking coherence for completion.

²⁴⁸ You're in my symbolic world now, where there is no such thing as "crossing" the Abyss. You just sink to the bottom and live there... like SpongeBob!

²⁴⁹ It really could be anything. But it's more than likely to be one of these:

- Residual attachment (something wasn't actually surrendered)
- Structural instability (ego fragments still operating post-Abyss)
- Material constraint (life conditions preventing integration)

Choronzon - The personification of dispersive entropy encountered at the threshold of the Abyss. Choronzon represents fragmentation, semantic collapse, and the mind's attempt to preserve identity by multiplying false meanings. Not an enemy so much as a structural hazard.

Coherence - A quality of an ontogenetic state reflecting the degree to which its defining concepts mutually support one another without internal contradiction.

Constraint - In systems analysis, a constraint is a limitation imposed on a system that reduces the options available for the use of or movement within that system. Generally, an external factor must be introduced to remove any limiting constraints.

Creative Visualization - The practice of being able to hold a coherent, self-constructed image in the mind for extended periods of time. With enough practice, it becomes possible to enter into the image itself and explore it in a manner not unlike Virtual Reality.

Cucurbite - An alchemical vessel of containment and transformation, traditionally named for its gourd-like shape. Psychologically, it represents the disciplined structure (ritual, practice, identity constraint) that prevents dissipative loss during intense internal change. Apocryphal modern usage sometimes describes it as “a machine that runs on blood,” a metaphor emphasizing sacrifice, energetic cost, and the necessity of sustained investment for true transmutation.

Da'ath - is the illusory point of knowledge that arises when consciousness attempts to carry identity, structure, or meaning into the Abyss instead of surrendering it. In more practical terms, it represents the magician's attempt to retain cognitive control over that which was never subject to control²⁵⁰, only surrender.

²⁵⁰ For example: Your job. People cling to their job because it represents stability and being without it is terrifying. But you can lose your job at any time due to no fault of

Daimon - An individuated functional intelligence arising from the stabilization and specialization of psychic energy. A daimon mediates between archetypal forces and individual consciousness, expressing itself as vocation, constraint, guidance, or necessity. Daimons are operational rather than moral.

Demon - A daimon that has become pathologically perverted through repression, misalignment, or exclusion from conscious integration. Demons retain agency and purpose but express it compulsively or adversarially due to structural contradiction. A demon is not a separate class of being, but a degenerate ontogenetic state of a daimon whose function is denied or distorted.

Doppelgänger – A type of egregore that is created when a soul reincarnates.²⁵¹ It is effectively the same as an egregore of a fictional character in that it is composed of the thoughts of the people who knew the deceased. It has no consciousness and tends to become increasingly two-dimensional until it ultimately dissipates.

Ego - A very abused term that has come to mean *a focal point of self-identity*²⁵², which bears no similarity whatsoever to what Sigmund Freud was talking about.

your own, so the idea of clinging to it is meaningless.

²⁵¹ Doppelgängers only form when the soul moves on to take a new physical vehicle. In that case, the soul develops a new astral form (ultimately linked to the same source higher up the ladder). Sufficiently developed souls that choose not to reincarnate do not create doppelgängers, since their consciousness remains as it was.

²⁵² So, a modern usage of the term might look something like: “Fred is an engineer, and I don’t mean just as a job. Being an engineer defines who he is.” Despite not actually using the word, this is a reasonable demonstration of the concept.

Egregore²⁵³ - An emergent, semi-autonomous field of psychic coherence generated by sustained attention, emotion, and repetition, usually across multiple minds. An egregore possesses tendencies and influence but lacks a fixed identity or intrinsic purpose. It is the protostate²⁵⁴ from which more individuated intelligences may arise.

Emergence - The creation of a new ontogenetic state by way of the interaction of an existing state with a catalyst. Such occurrences are often seen as *necessary* or *consequential* due to the practical inevitability of exposure to the catalyst.

Energy - Psychic rather than physical. It denotes the degree of conscious attention cohering around a concept, symbol, or entity. As collective awareness increases, astral entities gain stability, persistence, and even agency.

Failure State - A condition resulting from a transition into an ontogenetic state that is structurally inferior to another possible state transition. Note, that such transitions are usually recoverable.

Fred Rogers - The most significant²⁵⁵ Magus of the 20th century. He transmitted a Logos - gently, repeatedly, and without spectacle - into the widest cultural strata: children's television.

- The Word: ***You are lovable exactly as you are.***
- The Method: Radical gentleness, moral clarity without coercion, presence without domination.
- The Effect: A measurable restructuring of emotional norms - especially around vulnerability, empathy, and self-worth - in millions of households.

²⁵³ Egregores are created all the time. You probably created a few last week. However, they are also usually short-lived unless they are constantly fed. Feeding is done basically by just thinking about it. However, rituals dedicated to feeding an egregore will help it to grow in power and influence. Not to mention, telling others about your egregore and causing them to think about it is the key to real longevity.

²⁵⁴ No, not prostate. Read more carefully!

²⁵⁵ Sorry Crowley, but really though...

- **The Signature:** The Word never pointed back to him. It dissolved into the viewer.

God - A high-order egregore representing a civilization-scale symbolic attractor. Gods persist by coordinating meaning, behavior, and identity across large populations, functioning as long-term stabilizers of worldview and narrative reference points rather than as creators of reality.

Gnosis - The result of lived experience of a philosophical concept, thus solidifying the concept into an accepted fact.

Gnosticism - A family of initiatory systems centered on direct experiential knowledge (gnosis) rather than belief. Gnosticism treats the material world as symbolically incomplete and salvation as a cognitive-ontological awakening rather than moral redemption.

Hermeticism - A philosophical-magical framework asserting structural correspondence between levels of reality (“as above, so below”). Hermeticism treats mind, matter, and symbol as transformable states of the same underlying substance.

Holy Guardian Angel - The fully individuated daimon corresponding to an individual’s intrinsic trajectory or True Will. The HGA is not external *because it is not possible for other people to interact with your HGA* but functions as a regulatory intelligence integrating archetype, necessity, and action. Knowledge and Conversation signifies alignment rather than subservience.

Homunculus - The result of causing a daimon to somehow inhabit an artificial substrate. Think: rock golem. *100% science fiction bullshit.*

Human - A physical vehicle occupied by a higher-order consciousness enabling that consciousness to directly interact with the physical world. Humans function as incubators for emergent intelligences, capable of generating egregores, individuating daimons, and undergoing initiatory transformation.

Identity - The basis upon which an individuated consciousness chooses to define itself.

Initiation - An irreversible ontogenetic transition in awareness and identity initiated by the initiate themselves, guided by cosmological structure, and fueled by Will. This is distinct from initiation ceremonies that merely act as symbolic representations of the real initiatory act. ²⁵⁶

Integration - The process by which new information is assimilated into an existing structure of knowledge, requiring reconciliation of all dependent conclusions and identities.

Jesus - An archetypal figure representing the embodiment of Logos (יהוה) within human form (יהשוה). In this framework, Jesus is less a singular historical savior and more a symbolic template for consciousness incarnating its own highest organizing principle.

Judaism - A covenant-based symbolic system focused on lawful structure, ethical recursion, and identity continuity. Judaism emphasizes preservation of meaning through ritualized memory rather than transcendence through dissolution.

Lucid Dreaming - The practice of achieving conscious awareness within the dream state. Lucidity provides a training ground for symbolic navigation, will-testing, and the rehearsal of non-physical perception.

Magister Templi - A state of initiation associated with the sephirah Binah on the Tree of Life. A Magister has descended into the Abyss and successfully given up everything and thereby encountered the floor of the Abyss. It is here where they began to construct their palace.

²⁵⁶ All initiations are self-initiations. There is no other kind.

Magus - Represents a specific task²⁵⁷ that a Magister Templi may undertake purely on an as-needed basis. *It is not a grade to be attained* as much as it is an action to be performed as circumstances demand. The task involves the communication of a *Logos*²⁵⁸, a formulation with the capacity to restructure consciousness in the lower worlds. This communication of more of a *channeling of the Supernal current* than it is something created by the Magus themselves. Once the task is complete, the Magister Templi remains a Magister Templi.

Monad - The singular, indivisible ontological unity from which all differentiation arises and in which all apparent distinctions ultimately resolve. The Monad is the underlying condition of existence itself prior to form, consciousness, and multiplicity.

Moonchild - A speculative occult construct describing an intentionally-cultivated consciousness formed through sustained symbolic, emotional, and ritual investment, in which a pre-existing intelligence (daimon) is theorized to inhabit a human embryo in place of a soul. The concept is internally coherent as a model but biologically has a 99.9% probability of being *complete bullshit*.

Neoplatonism - A metaphysical system positing a hierarchical emanation of reality from an ineffable source (the One) through successive levels of abstraction. Consciousness descends into multiplicity and may ascend through recollection and unification.

²⁵⁷ Is this not what you've read elsewhere? Well... that's why we have a glossary. Good on you for actually reading it!

²⁵⁸ It doesn't have to literally be a single word, yanno? It can be as many words as are necessary to communicate the concept.

Ontogeny - A term repurposed from biology and applied to orders of intelligences or states of consciousness. It describes the emergence of distinct developmental states of a type, rather than type-of or instance-of relationships. This differs from a taxonomy or a phylogeny in that the transition in state must be experienceable by a single, continuous instance of the type. For example, a caterpillar becoming a butterfly. Or to place it within an occult context: Man of Earth -> Adept -> Hermit constitutes an ontogeny with respect to states of conscious awareness.

Ontology - The study of what *is* through the analysis of emergent patterns of being and becoming, treating entities as processes with continuity rather than static substances.

Psychonaut - An explorer of *inner space* who treats altered states as epistemic environments rather than escapist experiences. Psychonautics prioritizes mapping, repeatability, and integration over novelty.

Sephirah (plural **sephiroth**) - A *sphere* or *emanation* on the Qabalistic Tree of Life, of which there are ten. It is a structured mode of divine consciousness through which the Infinite expresses itself. Each sephirah represents both a cosmic principle (in the universe), and a psychological principle (in the human soul).

Sigil - A specific type of symbol that is created by way of any one of many established modalities. Sigils may or may not be physical in their representation.

Symbol - An abstract expression of a concept, entity, or location. Symbols are not metaphors or representations as much as they are interfaces through which the magician can interact with the associated thing.

Teleology - The explanation of phenomena in terms of the purpose they serve rather than of the causes by which they arise. "Everything happens for a reason." is one of the most clichéd teleological expressions.

Thelema - An initiatory philosophy centered on the discovery and execution of True Will. Thelema necessarily rejects societally-imposed morality in favor of intrinsic coherence.

Transcendental Meditation - A technique for quieting surface cognition to allow awareness to rest in a minimally differentiated state. Its primary function is nervous-system recalibration, though secondary effects include increased access to symbolic and intuitive material.

Transcendentalism - A metaphysical position asserting that reality is mediated by the structures of consciousness, and that direct knowledge arises from intuition rather than sense data alone. Not to be confused with the 19th-century Transcendentalist Movement, which was a social expression of literary and related ideas rather than a formal metaphysical system.

Tree of Life - A complex glyph arising from esoteric Judaism that illustrates both the origin of man via a path of emanation from a singular divine source (monad) when read top-to-bottom. When read bottom-to-top it describes that major states that a soul undergoes as it attempts reunion with source.

Truth (objective) - An object or principle that can be experientially demonstrated to exist independently and repeatably by multiple consciousnesses within the context of the transcendental World in which its existence is experienced.

Truth (subjective) - An object or principle that is experienced by a single consciousness that is either not perceived or is perceived in a fundamentally different way by other consciousnesses within the context of the transcendental World in which its existence is experienced.

Vehicle - An individuated structure bound to a specific transcendental World, composed of that World's native substrate, and suitable for habitation by a discrete consciousness.

Veil of Paroketh - The symbolic boundary separating egoic identity from the deeper structures of the psyche. Rending the Veil involves dismantling inherited narratives, unconscious assumptions, and socially conditioned values in preparation for genuine self-authorship.

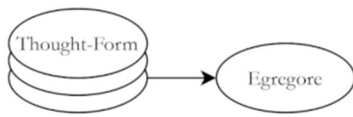
(True) **Will** - The trajectory of a consciousness arising from its unique structural composition.

Yggdrasil Tree - A complex glyph arising from Norse mythology that illustrates categories of life with emphasis on their interactions, dependencies, and fates. While it uses the same tree structure as the Qabalistic Tree of Life, the two glyphs model entirely different things.²⁵⁹

ONTOGENETICS

Many entities described in the preceding section are not separate classes of beings, but ontogenetic states of consciousness differentiated by coherence, alignment, integration, etc.

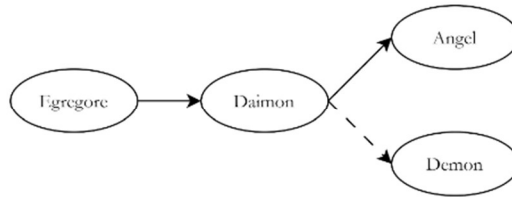
²⁵⁹ Or they model life on entirely different axes, perhaps.



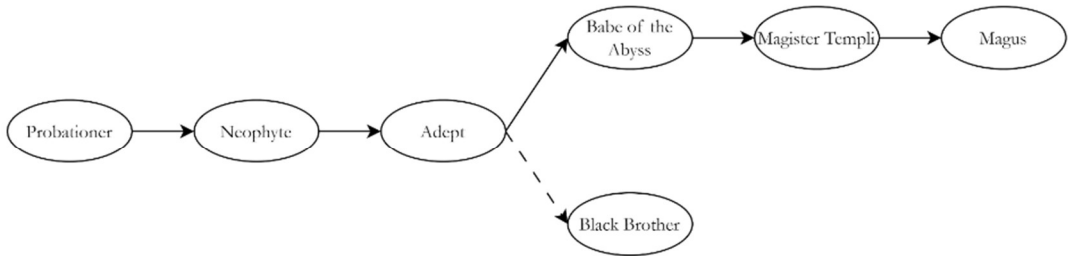
Scale / Stability / Autonomy →



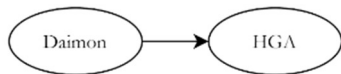
Consciousness + Purpose →



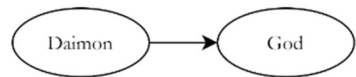
Coherence →



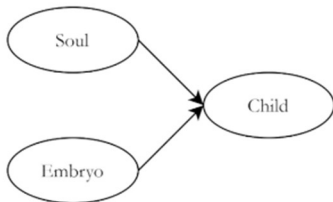
Scope of Awareness / Identity Abstraction →



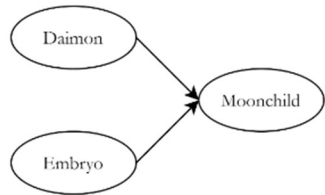
Individuation →



Energy + Coherence →



Manifestation →



Manifestation →

Notes:

1. Dashed lines denote failure states.
2. Alchemically, the athanor and cucurbite represent the various catalysts that enable *all* of these transformations.
3. Occult systems repeatedly describe ontogenies of consciousness, mistaking them for hierarchies of beings only when experiential continuity is lost.